

electrostatic potentials. This is a natural process. Pure Skies accelerates the natural process of agglomeration and dry deposition (settling of pollutant particles),” explains Dr Sola.

With a team of 20 people, Devic Earth brought down the size of the device to weigh six kilograms, from the initial weight of 200 kilograms, by using miniature versions of different components used. “We’ve also improved the software to make it more efficient. All our units are solar-powered and don’t need to be connected to the mains,” Dr Sola adds.

The company has successfully planted 27 machines in five different hotspots in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh as well as internationally in Chile, South America. “One machine will cover a radius of 250 to 500 metres. This way we are able to cover large areas by putting them on building rooftops,” Dr Sola says.

The startup customises the antennas and some of the components with help from external partners. It sources a few EU-certified components from Lithuania which, the startup claims, are cheaper. The company works with manufacturing vendors to build the housing and PCB boards and programs each unit once it reaches the Devic Earth plant.



Devic Earth team with their founder Dr Srikanth Sola (centre, seated)

It is currently looking to partner with local manufacturers in Bengaluru for manufacturing IP65 (for protection from rain) or even higher standard enclosures to protect the components and keep them safe and dry.

Dr Sola believes that funding is like oxygen for a startup. The company raised \$1.4 million from Singapore-based investment firm Blue Ashva Sampada Capital in January 2021. The startup was incubated under the Karnataka Innovation Technology Society (KITS), which referred it to labs that could certify the technology. “It’s not cost-efficient for a small startup to create a huge testing lab on its own. It’s too expensive. With the help of KITS, we’ve been able to access testing

labs and certification facilities for our ongoing research and product development,” clarifies Dr Sola.

As a part of its future projects, the company is working on a carbon capture technology for ambient carbon dioxide, which is one of the main greenhouse gases. It is also coming up with a personal air purifier that would be the size of a car keychain. “You can carry it with you and clip it onto your backpack, purse, or briefcase. You can have an air purifier with you wherever you go!” exclaims Dr Sola.

The company is currently looking at expanding all across India, and internationally into the Middle East, Europe, and North America.

—Yashasvini Razdan

2 ‘EAGLE’ SOARING HIGH THANKS TO DEEP TECH

Gurugram-based TechEagle is India’s leading drone startup, which boasts of having delivered Asia’s first vaccine via drone in Telangana in 2021. But there’s more to this 2015-born company, which is working to holistically solve the healthcare and logistics problem of our times by combining aerospace, electronics, sensory tech, lidar, optical sensors, AI-vision, and 5G

